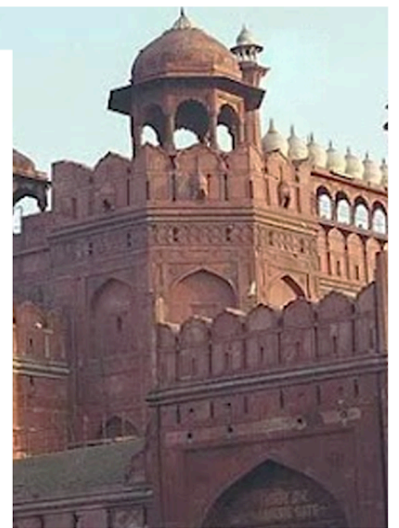
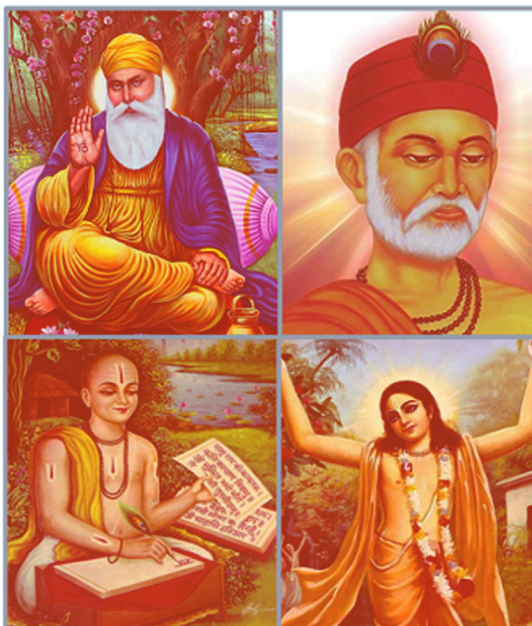
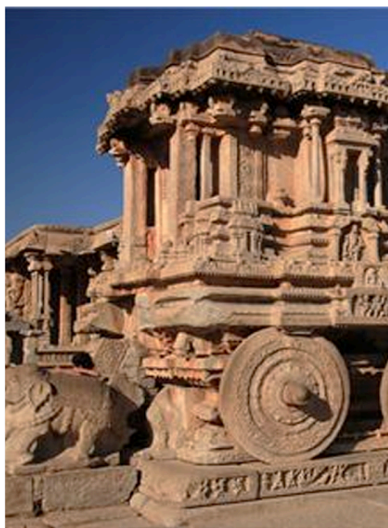


General Knowledge

Medieval History

STUDY NOTES

Rashtrakutas



Rashtrakutas Empire

Rashtrakutas: Important rulers

- Rashtrakutas were found to be **vassals/feudal under Chalukyas** before coming to power.
- It is evident from the earlier records of Chalukyas on inscriptions found mentioning it.

Dantidurga (Founder) (735 - 756)

- Dantidurga, also known as Dantivarma, was Feudatory of the Chalukya king, Kirtivarman II, and also defeated who later founded the Rashtrakuta kingdom by taking the Gurjaras of control of the northern regions of the Chalukya,
- Malwa was brought under the control of the Empire and thus ascended to the throne in c.733 CE.
- However, the Rashtrakutas as a kingdom rose in Kosala and power from c.753 CE. in Srisailam.
- His name '**Dantidurga**' (meaning he whose elephant is his fortress) also signifies his military feats and accomplishments.
- He also helped his father-in-law, the Pallava King Nandivarmana, to regain Kanchi from the Chalukyas.

Krishna I (756 - 774)

- Krishna I succeeded Dantidurga.
- He conquered the territories that were still under the Chalukyas
- He was a great patron of art and architecture.
- The **Kailash Temple at Ellora was built by Krishna I.**
- The temple is carved out of a massive block of rock measuring 200 feet long, and 100 feet in breadth and height.
- The construction **style is rock-cut so it is done from a top-down approach.** The construction is started from the top.
- The central face of the plinth has imposing figures of elephants and lions which give an impression that the entire structure rests on their back.

Govinda III (793 - 814)

- **Govinda III** was the **greatest monarch** of the **Rashtrakuta dynasty.**

- He succeeded his renowned father, **Dhruva Dharavarsha**.
- Militarily, Govinda III was the **most successful emperor** of the Rashtrakutas.
- His **conquests** extended from **Kanyakumari** (south) to **Kanyakubja** (north), and from **Banaras** (east) to **Bharuch** (west).
- He defeated the great Gurjara King Nagabhatta II.
- Pala King Dharmapala and his protégé Charayudh sought the help of Govinda III.
- **His kingdom spread up to the Vindhyas and Malava in the north and the river Tungabhadra to the south.**

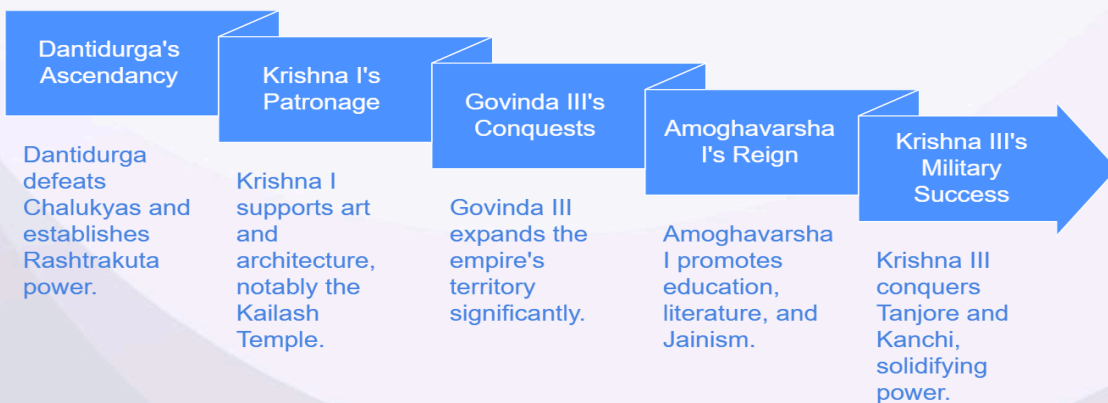
Amoghavarsha I (814- 878 A.D.)

- The greatest king of the Rashtrakuta dynasty was Amoghavarsha I son of Govinda III. He ruled for 63 years.
- Amoghavarsha I set up a new capital at **Manyakheta** (now Malkhed in Karnataka State) and Broach became the best part of the kingdom during his reign.
- Amoghavarsha- I was a great patron of education and literature.
- Amoghavarsha was converted to Jainism by Jinasena, a Jaina monk.
- **Suleman, an Arab merchant**, in his account called **Amoghavarsha I** as one of the four greatest kings of the world, the other three being the Caliph of Bagdad, the king of Constantinople and the emperor of China.

Krishna III (939 – 967)

- The last powerful and efficient king of the Rashtrakutas.
- He also succeeded in **conquering Tanjore and Kanchi**.
- He succeeded in **defeating the Tamil kings of the Chola kingdom**.

Evolution of the Rashtrakuta Dynasty





Literature and Architecture Under Rashtrakutas

Literature

- Though Rashtrakutas widely patronised Sanskrit literature, the Kannada language also got contributions from Rashtrakutas.
- Rashtrakutas were **great patrons of Literature and Art**.
- Many **Sanskrit and Kannada** works were composed during the regime.
- **Kavirajamarga** composed by Amogavarsha was the **first poetic work in the Kannada language**.
- **Jinasena wrote the Adipurana**, the life stories of various **Jain** saints.
- **Pampa** was the greatest of the **Kannada** poets and **Vikramasenavijaya** is his famous work.
- **Santipurana** was another great work written by Ponna, another famous **Kannada** poet.
- **Viracharya** – a Great **mathematician** of this period wrote **Ganitasaram**.
- **Sakatayana** wrote **Amogavritti**, a **grammar** work.

- **Jinasena** composed *Parsvabhudaya*, a biography of Parsva in verses.

Architecture: Dravidian Style

- The features of the Dravidian temple are *straight Vimanas, Pillared mandapas, Torana/entrance gateway/Gopurams*.
- Kailashnatha temple has a three-tiered shikhara or tower which resembles the *share* of the Mamallapuram rathas.
- There is a pillared hall with **16 square pillars** in the interior of the temple.
- A sculpture of the Goddess Durga is engraved as slaying the Buffalo demon.
- The above features are part of the **Dravidian style of architecture**
- The sculpture of the Goddess Durga is shown as slaying the Buffalo demon.
- In another sculpture, Ravana was making attempts to lift Mount Kailasa, the abode of Siva.

Kailashnatha Temple

- **Krishna- I** built the **Kailash Temple at Ellora**.
- The temple is carved out of a massive block of rock measuring 200 feet long, and 100 feet in breadth and height.
- The construction **style is rock-cut so it is done from a top-down approach**. The construction is started from the top.
- The central face of the plinth has imposing figures of elephants and lions which give an impression that the entire structure rests on their back.

Society and religion

- **Saivism and Vaisnavism** flourished.
- Temples like the **Ellora temple** have evidence of **Hindu** mythology
- Prevalence of **Jainism** was also found.
- Important Jainism development was that **King Amogavarsha was converted to Jainism by Jinasena**, a Jaina monk.
- People spoke Kannada and **Kannada literature started developing** during this time

Trade

- Rashtrakutas controlled parts from **Malwa in the northwest to Kanchi in the southeast**.

- West coast was under their control and overseas **trade links were established between Arabs and Deccan.**
- **Bharuch(Baroach)** was an important port that flourished then.
- It is situated in the present-day state of **Gujarat.**